Theme 2: Starting University

🇫🇷 Across Cultures: France & Rumaitha Al Busaidi

Lesson 2-6
Book pages 28-32

💡 **Big idea:** **France** is the largest country in Western Europe, famous for Paris, the Eiffel Tower and its food. In **Reading for Pleasure** we meet **Rumaitha Al Busaidi**, an Omani marine scientist who joined an expedition to the **Antarctic** in 2014.

🎯 **I will learn:**
- Learn facts about France
- Read an interview with an inspiring Omani
- Discuss following your passion
- Review the theme glossary

📖 Key words

expedition بعثة / رحلة استكشافية	**environmentalist** ناشط بيئي	**passion** شغف	**Antarctic** القارة القطبية الجنوبية
sponsor راعٍ / ممول	**acclimatise** يتأقلم مع المناخ	**revolution** ثورة	**terrifying** مرعب

France facts

- Capital: Paris
- population: 67 million
- currency: Euro
- Mont Blanc (4,810 m) is the highest point in Western Europe
- Main rivers: Seine, Loire, Garonne, Rhône
- The French Revolution began on 14 July 1789 (storming of the Bastille)
- Fast trains (TGV) and the Channel Tunnel link France and England

Rumaitha Al Busaidi: Preserving the Antarctic

- She studied environmental science in the Netherlands
- She joined the '2041' expedition started by Robert Swan to preserve the Antarctic
- She trained for a whole year, including in a freezer at minus 20 degrees
- There were 88 participants from 28 countries
- Her advice: 'Build your career around what you love.'

Official name:	French Republic
Location:	Western Europe
Capital:	Paris
Population:	67 million
Area:	551,500 km^2
Languages:	French
Currency:	Euro



France fact file (p.28)

✏️ Examples

What is Rumaitha's advice to young people?

Answer: Build your career around what you love; that's the secret to a successful career.

When did the French Revolution begin?

Answer: On 14 July 1789, when a crowd stormed the Bastille.

⭐ Remember

- Interviews are organised as questions and answers: read the questions first to find information quickly.

⚠️ Watch out

- ✗ Rumaitha travelled to the Arctic. ✓ She travelled to the Antarctic (the South Pole region).

🧩 **Activity:** Write notes for visitors about Oman's main attractions for your portfolio.

✅ Check yourself

1. Capital of France?
2. Highest point in Western Europe?
3. Where did Rumaitha study?
4. How long did she train?

Answers: (1) Paris ، (2) Mont Blanc ، (3) the Netherlands ، (4) a whole year